

Canon PowerShot A60/A70

Sibling rivalry

Canon has introduced two cameras with very little difference between them, to cater to budget buyers and enthusiasts. The A60 and A70 have a long list of common features—both support a shutter speed from 15 seconds to 1/2000th of a second, which is one of the widest ranges in their class. You get sufficiently bright pictures under poor light conditions. Both support 1600 x 1200 and 2048 x 1536 resolutions, but are bundled with 16 MB Compact Flash. Canon should have bundled at least 32 MB with the A70, as it supports higher resolution settings. Both these devices need four AA batteries to run. The camera provides manual overriding of many settings but tweaking the settings requires the LCD to be on, which consumes a lot of power. Therefore, it is



advisable to use auto settings as far as possible, and an optical viewfinder, instead of an LCD, while shooting. Both these devices allow you to capture pictures in black and white, and sepia modes that can be used to make project reports and presentations that are pleasing to the eye. The cameras also allow you to set the expo-

sure value from +2 to -2 EV. Use this setting if you understand the kind of output that will come out after setting the EV.

There was hardly any difference in their performance, with the A70 taking a 2 per cent lead over A60 because of a 3.2 megapixel CCD. As far as luminosity goes, the test image quality of the A60 was better than the A70—the A60 came up with a more pleasing and brighter image. But when picking the colour blue, the A70 performed better than the A60. On the other hand, the A70 shone in the details test where one could see each individual thread on the lace. This can be attributed to better focusing and higher resolution support. The A70 also generated a smooth specular effect, which was a little blunt in A60.

The A60 and A70 are available for Rs 24,995 and Rs 29,995, respectively. Both these cameras only differ in optical and digital zoom, and CCD size. The looks and button placement are also similar with the same body used. Given the quality they deliver and features set they carry, their price seems just right.

- + Good features
 - Expensive
- Price:** Rs 24,995

Canon PowerShot A60 C+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

- + Good ergonomics with decent features
 - Does not live up to the features.
- Price:** Rs 29,995

Canon PowerShot A70 C+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

Sony DSC-P72 and DSC-P32 Digital cameras

Cute couple

Sony's Cyber-shot DSC-P72 and DSC-P32 are identical in all respect, except for the fact that the P72 comes equipped with a 3X optical zoom, whereas the P32 has a fixed focus lens.



The cameras don't have a silver finish on a plastic body that has one end rounded off. The back has a cluster of buttons that consists of a mode selector switch, four menu navigation buttons and an Enter button.

Three other buttons—used for menu activation and deleting the picture in the play mode—are lined along the LCD monitor that acts as a view-finder. The cameras do have rubber padding for a firm grip.

Both sport the a 3.2 megapixel CCD sensor, with a maximum resolution of 2048 X 1536. They have five white-balance modes, and shutter speeds ranging from 2 secs. to 1/1000 of a second. ISO speeds range from 100 to 400, thus allowing for improved CCD gain in poor lighting. They also have five flash modes for varying lighting conditions.

The cameras were nearly on par with each other in terms of performance. In the image test, the P32 reproduced images that had good tonal balance than the P72. Also in the luminosity test, the P32 turned up better photos than the P72. However, where the specular effect and gradation in shading is concerned, the P72 scored due to its optical zoom. Similarly, in the details test, the P72 scored over the P32, only by reproducing the finer details better. The P32 crushed the P72 in the RGB test by reproducing the target in its full vibrancy. In the zoom test, again the P72 armed with its superior optical zoom lens, performed better than the P32. So was the case in the actual person test, only the margin was wider. The DSC-P32 and DSC-P72 cost Rs 19,990 and Rs 24,990, respectively—too much to ask for with those features and performance.



"Very, very, very, sharp images with a strong depth-of-field. Too many buttons. And thankfully is a Made-in-Japan. Is well priced, looks different in comparison with other digicams and is a Sony."

—Sherwin Crasto

- + Good features at an attractive price
 - None
- Price:** Rs 19,990

Sony DSC-P32 B-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

- + Good features, form factor
 - Small and cramped LCD monitor
- Price:** Rs 24,990

Sony DSC-P72 C+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶
Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶

